

What's
News

Business & Finance

◆ Meta is discussing moving its incorporation to Texas from Delaware, where most big U.S. companies are legally housed, people familiar with the matter said. The paperwork change wouldn't relocate its California corporate headquarters. **B9**

◆ OpenAI's Sam Altman said his company should consider giving away its AI models, a potentially seismic shift as China's DeepSeek has upended the AI industry. **B9**

◆ The estate of Joseph Shuster, the co-creator of "Superman," is suing Warner Bros. Discovery and DC Comics, alleging overseas copyright infringement. **B9**

◆ Novartis forecasts further profit and sales growth this year after beating analysts' expectations in the fourth quarter of 2024. **B10**

◆ Walgreens will suspend its quarterly dividend, citing its need for cash amid litigation and turnaround efforts. **B10**

◆ The annual profits of Exxon Mobil and Chevron fell in 2024, as anemic natural-gas prices and narrowed refining margins took a toll. **B11**

◆ Financial markets finished a bumpy month broadly higher, with the Dow, S&P 500 and Nasdaq gaining 4.7%, 2.7% and 1.6%, respectively, in January. **B11**

World- Wide

◆ The U.S. will impose tariffs on computer chips, pharmaceuticals, steel, aluminum, copper, oil and gas imports as soon as mid-February, Trump said, opening a new front in his looming second-term trade wars. **A1, A2**

◆ The Army helicopter that collided with an American Airlines flight was training to transport top U.S. leaders to a safe zone in the event of an attack on the capital. **A6**

◆ Trump administration officials ordered eight senior FBI employees to resign or be fired, and asked for a list of people who worked on the Jan. 6 cases, people familiar with the matter said. **A3**

◆ Universities are suspending research projects, canceling conferences and closing offices in response orders from Trump banning DEI across the U.S. government. **A3**

◆ Venezuela released six detained Americans, after a meeting between Maduro and a visiting U.S. envoy. **A8**

◆ Israel is accusing Iranian diplomats and others of smuggling tens of millions of U.S. dollars stuffed into suitcases through the Beirut airport to the militant group Hezbollah. **A7**

◆ Hamas named the next three hostages to be freed under the Gaza cease-fire deal, including the first American to be released in the latest truce. **A7**

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Trump and the collapse of the old order **A13**

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Crash Victims Mourned Amid Search for Answers



GRIEF: Roberto Marquez sets up a memorial Friday near Ronald Reagan Washington National Airport in Arlington, Va., as crews worked to recover bodies from the Potomac River after the midair collision between a passenger jet and an Army helicopter.

‘Can’t Wait to Be Home’: Final Moments of Flight 5342

Rowan Le Coq, a 17-year-old ice dancer, considered his best friend Spencer Lane more than just a fellow skater—he

By Valerie Bauerlein, Scott Calvert, Allison Pohle and Louise Radnofsky

was like a brother. They traded daily messages about their dreams of athletic glory, but also spent hours doing what teenage boys do: sharing

TikToks and playing Roblox. They had both traveled from the East Coast to Wichita, Kan., for the U.S. Figure Skating Championships, where Rowan was competing in the junior event, and Spencer, 16, had been invited for an elite development camp, proudly wearing the coveted red jacket given to young skaters chosen for the program.

The friends had planned to play “Cabin Crew,” a favorite flight-attendant simulation

game, in the lobby of the Drury Plaza Hotel in Wichita, but time slipped away. No problem, they assured each other—they would connect again soon at “SCOB,” the Skating Club of Boston, where Spencer trained.

On Wednesday afternoon, Rowan, who had gone home earlier, messaged Spencer to see if he was “still at Drury.” Spencer’s reply was simple, the kind you dash off when you’re certainly going to write

more later: “nah i leave now.”

When he heard that American Airlines Flight 5342 from Wichita had collided with a helicopter and plunged into the Potomac River, Rowan frantically checked Spencer’s location again. It showed Indiana—the last update registered from the flight.

At 11:49 p.m., he sent a des-

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◆ Helicopter helped to ferry top officials..... A6

DeepSeek Pride Is Sweeping Over China

By LIYAN QI

In China, DeepSeek’s sudden shot to fame with artificial-intelligence models rivaling American ones has inspired a moment of national pride.

In a week where attention on DeepSeek’s low-cost AI models caused a bloodbath on Wall Street and propelled DeepSeek’s app to the top of iPhone download rankings in the U.S., China was celebrating. Emojis of “DeepSeek pride,” often with smiling cats or dogs, flooded Chinese social media, adding to the festive Lunar New Year atmosphere.

Chinese state media, as well as tech and business leaders, raved about DeepSeek. “We need to believe that the moon in other countries is not necessarily rounder: Whatever others can do, we can also do it and even do it better,” read a profile of DeepSeek, published by the government of Zhejiang province, where the company is located.

Local media reported that the small Guangdong province hometown of DeepSeek founder Liang Wenfeng has become a hot destination for tourists during the weeklong Lunar New Year holiday.

In China, the buzz around DeepSeek is so intense that it has even led to a local media report that the small Guangdong province hometown of DeepSeek founder Liang Wenfeng has become a hot destination for tourists during the weeklong Lunar New Year holiday.

◆ Deep freak: What happens next in AI B1
◆ Altman suggests giving away OpenAI tech..... B9

Trump, Facing Two Crises, Spreads the Blame Around

By NATALIE ANDREWS AND MERIDITH MCGRAW

WASHINGTON—President Trump’s handling of two crises this past week—one, a bureaucratic mess and the other, a horrific tragedy—quickly shifted the White House from inaugural euphoria to the realities of governing.

His defiant stand in the face of nationwide confusion and fear left some aides scrambling to fortify the image of a White House that could do no wrong. But he handled both problems with the same approach: deflecting blame and attacking

Democrats, the media and his predecessors. His message was an amplified version of what he has tried to exude since taking office: He is in charge.

The country also received its first live-action glimpse of a White House and cabinet being hastily assembled and crafting policies on the fly that in one case had to be quickly reversed.

On Monday, a memo written by an acting director of the White House’s budget office caused a widespread panic and might have inadvertently led the Medicaid system to freeze in less than 24 hours. On Thursday, Trump’s new De-

fense and Transportation chiefs were thrust in the middle of investigating the worst domestic airplane crash in two decades.

As Trump introduced Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy, the president said, “It’s not your fault, and I know you agree with me very strongly on intellect and even psychological well-being of the air-traffic controller.”

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◆ Universities retreat in wake of Trump moves... A3
◆ Aid whiplash hits refugees, AIDS patients globally... A7

These People Come for the Magic
Of the Movie Ad Everyone Hates

* * *

Nicole Kidman spot has long been mocked.
But when it vanished, theatergoers rose up.

By JOSEPH PISANI

Fans were just settling into their seats to watch Nicole Kidman’s new film “Babygirl” when a scandal erupted. It had nothing to do with the movie, an erotic thriller starring the actress as a CEO who has a torrid affair with a much younger intern. The real shock was what didn’t appear on screen: a 30-second ad that plays before almost



Nicole Kidman

every film at AMC theaters. Since it first appeared four years ago, few things have divided moviegoers more than the commercial, in which Kidman walks into an empty theater, stares at the screen and touts the virtues of the theatergoing experience. “We come to this place for magic,” she says. The ad has been mocked, spoofed and criticized as redundant. Please turn to page A9

Was That a Van Gogh At the Garage Sale?

By KELLY CROW

In 1889, Vincent van Gogh committed himself to a psychiatric asylum in Southern France, where he spent a turbulent year creating roughly 150 paintings, including masterpieces such as “Irises,” “Almond Blossom” and “The Starry Night.”

Now, a former curator of ancient art at the Metropolitan Museum of Art has teamed up with a group of conservators, scientists and historians who believe they’ve discovered No. 151—a previously unknown portrait of a fisherman plucked from a Minnesota garage sale by an unsuspecting antiques

President Threatens To Widen Trade War

Trump plans sector-based levies on eve of expected Mexico-Canada-China duties

The U.S. will impose tariffs on computer chips, pharmaceuticals, steel, aluminum, copper, oil and gas imports as soon as mid-February, President Trump said Friday, opening a new front in his looming second-term trade wars.

By Gavin Bade and Natalie Andrews in Washington, Vipal Monga in Toronto and Santiago Pérez in Mexico City

“That’ll happen fairly soon,” Trump told reporters in the Oval Office, adding that he also wants to hike tariffs on the European Union, which has “treated us so horribly,” though he didn’t specify when the duties would be imposed or how high they would be.

A representative for the EU didn’t respond to a request for comment.

The announcement for those sector-based and EU tariffs appeared separate from the 25% tariffs on Canada and Mexico, and 10% tariffs on China, which he had said would be implemented Saturday.

The duties previewed by Trump would come on top of existing tariffs on those products, he said, waving away any concern about the levies increasing inflation or snarling global supply chains.

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◆ Expect tariffs to bring confusion, higher prices... A2
◆ Auto companies scramble to make Plan B, C, D..... B1

Stocks Log January Gain

Major stock indexes fell Friday but rose for the month. **B11**

